

Codebook

for

Bureaucratic Turnover Under New Governments: The Moderating Effect of Bureaucratic and Political Layering

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1 Structure of the Codebook and Data Processing

1.1 Structure of the Codebook

This codebook documents the four datasets gathered for and used in the paper *Bureaucratic Turnover Under New Governments: The Moderating Effect of Bureaucratic and Political Layering*. The codebook is organized into four parts, one for each dataset:

- **Part I:** TCS_NOR — The main dataset of the paper, containing yearly observations of Norwegian top civil servants (TCS), Permanent Secretaries, Assistant Permanent Secretaries, and Directors General, between 1884 and 2024. This is the dataset on which the analyses in the paper are run.
- **Part II:** Governments_NOR — A dataset with information about each Norwegian government during the period.
- **Part III:** Ministers_NOR — A dataset with information about Norwegian ministers during the period.
- **Part IV:** POLADV_NOR — A dataset with information about Norwegian state secretaries and political advisors during the period.

The three datasets (Governments_NOR, Ministers_NOR, and POLADV_NOR) describe the political context in each year of the observation period. They are the source datasets from which the government-, minister-, and political appointee-level variables in TCS_NOR were constructed (see Sections 10–15 in Part I).

1.1.1 Linking Records Across Datasets

Each dataset contains its own person identifier: PersonID in TCS_NOR, and ID in Ministers_NOR and POLADV_NOR.

These identifiers are internal to each dataset: they identify a person only within the dataset in which they appear and do *not* take the same value for the same person across datasets. They should therefore not be used to merge records between datasets.

To link the same person across the four datasets, use the `first_name_last_name_year_born` variable, which is constructed identically in every dataset (a concatenation of first name, last name, and year of birth). The corresponding variable for a referenced minister — `minister_first_name_last_name_year_born` in TCS_NOR and POLADV_NOR — links to the minister's record (`first_name_last_name_year_born`) in Ministers_NOR.

The dataset also contains NSD_Person_ID, which is Sikt's own identifier for politicians and can be used to connect the data on ministers and state secretaries, as well as, top civil servants and political advisors who at one point in their careers served had a stint as either minister, state secretary or parliamentarian, to Sikt's Data on the political system (Sikt, n.d.a).

Other cross-dataset keys:

- **Ministries** are linked across all datasets through `ministry_NSD_ID` (Sikt's organizational identifier, which is stable and consistent across the datasets).
- **Governments** are linked between `Governments_NOR` and `Ministers_NOR` through `government_version`. Note that the `government` variable in `POLADV_NOR` follows Regjeringen.no's classification and is *not* equivalent to `government_version`.

1.2 Data Collection

The `TCS_NOR` dataset consists of 948 different people who held top civil servant positions (referred to as senior bureaucrat positions in the paper) throughout the period. Data collection was carried out by the author between 2021 and 2025. The primary source of data on when senior bureaucrats were in office is the yearly published Norwegian register of government employees, *Statskalenderen* (Regjeringen, 1877–2011). Data collection primarily involved “digital archival work”, as the Norwegian State Calendars have been digitized and OCR-processed by the Norwegian National Library (NB.no). This also means that extending the dataset to cover more positions can more easily be done in the future through partially automated methods. All state calendars can be found at:

<https://www.nb.no/search?q=Statskalender&mediatype=tidsskrift>

The final publication year of the government employees' register was 2011. Data on senior bureaucrats in the 2012–2024 period has therefore been scraped from the minutes of Council of State meetings, *Offisielt frå statsrådet* (Regjeringen, 1994–2024), which cover all senior bureaucrat appointments. Since the minutes from Council of State meetings only provide information about the appointment of new senior bureaucrats, and not their exit times, exits in this period have been coded manually using archived government webpages (the Internet Archive's Wayback Machine, 2023), LinkedIn, newspaper archives, and official documents—such as department–agency contracts or responses to public hearings signed by the top bureaucrat with their official title—to establish whether they were still in office.

The data on executive politicians (governments and ministers) and political appointees (state secretaries and political advisors) covers the full population in the period 1884–2024 and is mainly based on data from the official webpages of the Norwegian government and parliament. All base information about ministers, governments, state secretaries, and political advisors can be found at:

<https://www.regjeringen.no/no/om-regjeringa/tidligere-regjeringer-og-historie/id85847/>

In general, the datasets were constructed using a mix of manual coding and manual searches where necessary, and web scraping and/or machine learning methods where possible.

Secondary Data Sources

Beyond the primary sources described above, the datasets draw on the following existing datasets (full citations appear in the References Section 32.5).

- **Sikt — Data on the political system** (Sikt, n.d.a). Source of information on ministers, state secretaries, and members of parliament.
- **Sikt — The Norwegian State Administration Database** (Sikt, n.d.b). Source of information about ministries, agencies, and how they have been organized over time.
- **Norwegian Parliamentary Elections** (Fiva & Smith, 2024). A candidate-level source covering Norwegian parliamentary elections.
- **Local Candidate Dataset** (Fiva, Sørensen & Vøllo, 2024). A candidate-level source covering Norwegian local and regional elections (1971–2023).
- **Statistics Norway — name register** (SSB, 2024). Used to code the gender variable from first names.

A note on NSD and Sikt: When data collection started, Sikt was named NSD (the Norwegian Centre for Research Data). The organization has since been renamed, but the variable names in these datasets retain the NSD prefix for data originating from Sikt. The NSD identifiers are Sikt’s own ID codes — `NSD_Person_ID` for individuals and `ministry_NSD_ID` for organizational structure — and can be used to connect these datasets to Sikt’s data (see Section 1.1.1).

1.3 Data Protection and Ethics

All data in this project come from publicly available sources and concern political elites: cabinet ministers, senior bureaucrats, state secretaries, political advisors, and members of parliament. These are individuals who have held positions of considerable public interest, and they are studied on that basis. The selection of actors for such positions and their influence on public decision-making are important societal questions, particularly since these actors in the parliamentary delegation chain are meant to be accountable to the state’s citizens.

The data collection has been assessed by Sikt — the Norwegian Agency for Shared Services in Education and Research; for information on Sikt’s services, see sikt.no/en/data-protection-services. Please be aware that merging these datasets with other individual-level datasets may require additional approval from the relevant data protection authorities.

Every effort has been made to ensure the highest quality in the data; however, no responsibility is assumed for any residual errors. If you discover an error, please inform the author by email with the necessary documentation.

Much of this codebook was drafted by Claude using the author’s R-scripts for dataset construction, an earlier version of the codebook, and extensive data collection notes. The author has edited and validated the codebook contents. If you discover an error in the codebook, please inform the author by email with the necessary documentation.

1.4 Variables Used in the Paper

Table 1 lists the variables used in *Bureaucratic Turnover Under New Governments: The Moderating Effect of Bureaucratic and Political Layering*, the names under which they appear in the paper's tables and figures, and their variable names in the TCS_NOR dataset as documented in Part I of this codebook.

Table 1: Mapping of variable names in the paper to variable names in TCS_NOR.

Name in paper	Variable in TCS_NOR	Role in analysis
Senior Bureaucrat Turnover	bureaucrat_turnover	Dependent variable
Change of Government	GOV_turnover	Independent variable
Bureaucratic Buffer	bureaucratic_buffer	Moderator
Bureaucratic Buffer & Position Type	bureaucratic_buffer_i	Moderator
Political Amplifier	state_secretaries_NSDID	Moderator
Senior Bureaucrat Tenure (<i>Time</i>)	time	Fixed effects
Decade	decade	Fixed effects
Ministry Fixed Effects	ministry_NSD_ID	Fixed effects
Election Year	election_year	Control
Before-1906	post_1906 (reversed) ^a	Control
Age	age_year	Control
Gender	gender	Control
Temporary Appointment	temporary_employment	Control
Within/Between Ministry Switching and Promotion/Demotion	bureaucrat_turnover4	Alternative Dependent variable
Time Period	time_period	Additional Moderator
Change of Government ($t - 1$)	GOV_turnover_lagged	Alternative Independent variable
Change of Government ($t + 1$)	GOV_turnover_lead	Alternative Independent variable
Change of Minister	minister_turnover	Alternative Independent variable
Party Incongruence	match_start_end_PMparty (reversed) ^a	Alternative Independent variable
PM-Party's Share of Cabinet Seats	government_PMparty_share_posts_end_of_year	Robustness
Time Since Ministry Created	years_since_ministry_creation_year	Robustness
Ministry Terminated	dep_end	Robustness
Multiple Level 1 Bureaucrats	ministry_multiple_L1	Robustness
Age Group	age_group_year	Robustness
Including Between Ministry Switching	bureaucrat_turnover2	Robustness
Including Between Ministry Switching and Promotion/Demotion	bureaucrat_turnover3	Robustness
Including Within/Between Ministry Switching and Promotion/Demotion	bureaucrat_turnover4	Robustness
Years Since Introduction of Permanent Secretary as Level 1	time_period_since_PS_in_min	Robustness

^a Recoded in the analysis scripts (data-preparation.R): pre_1906 = 1 - post_1906;
match_start_end_PMparty_flipped = 1 - match_start_end_PMparty.

Part I

The Main Dataset: TCS_NOR

2 About the Dataset

The TCS_NOR (Top Civil Servants Norway) dataset contains information about all Directors General (*Ekspedisjonsjefer*), Assistant Permanent Secretaries (*Assisterende departementsråder*), and Permanent Secretaries (*Departementsråder*) in Norwegian ministries between 1884 and 2024. The dataset covers the period from the introduction of parliamentarism in Norway (1884) to the present.

The dataset is structured as **top civil servant–year** observations. Each row represents one top civil servant in one year.

3 Identification, Personal Characteristics, and Education

3.1 year

Numeric. The calendar year of the observation. A civil servant is included in a given year if they hold a top civil servant position as of 1 January of that year.

3.2 PersonID

Numeric. A unique identifier for each individual civil servant *within this dataset*. Constructed by grouping on last name, first name, and year of birth. An official retains the same PersonID across different ministries or spells in TCS_NOR, but this identifier does not link to the same person in the other datasets (see Section 1.1.1).

3.3 NSD_Person_ID

Numeric. The NSD (Norwegian Centre for Research Data) person identifier. Missing for top civil servants who have not held a position covered in Sikt (n.d.a).

3.4 last_name

String. The civil servant’s last name, as recorded in the *Statskalenderen* or other sources. Persons with a “von” prefix in their surname have this included.

3.5 first_name

String. The civil servant's first name and, where applicable, a hyphenated double first name (e.g. "Hans-Henrik").

3.6 middle_name

String. The civil servant's middle name, where available.

3.7 year_born

Numeric. The civil servant's year of birth (four digits, e.g. 1943).

3.8 first_name_last_name_year_born

String. A concatenation of first name, last name, and year of birth without spaces (e.g. OlajOlsen1851). This is the key used to link the same person across all four datasets (see Section 1.1.1).

3.9 age_year

Numeric. The civil servant's age in the observation year, calculated as $\text{year} - \text{year_born}$.

3.10 age_at_start

Numeric. The civil servant's age at the start of their employment spell, calculated as $\text{start_year} - \text{year_born}$. See Section 7 for definition of `start_year`.

3.11 age_group_year

Categorical. A three-category grouping of `age_year`:

- **Less than 50** — $\text{age_year} < 50$
- **50s** — $50 \leq \text{age_year} < 60$
- **60s** — $\text{age_year} \geq 60$

3.12 gender

Dummy. Gender of the civil servant: 0 = man, 1 = woman. Coded based on the civil servant's first name and Statistics Norway's (SSB) name registry.

3.13 party_long

Categorical. The political party affiliation of the civil servant, if any. Derived by matching civil servants to datasets on ministers, members of parliament, state secretaries, and political advisors. Takes the value of the party they were affiliated with in those roles. Civil servants with no registered political career are coded NA.

3.14 education_level

Categorical. The highest completed level of education, as listed in the *Statskalenderen*, *Offisielt fra statsråd*, or the *Personal Information* dataset. Note this information may be incomplete. Values: Master's degree, Bachelor's degree, Doctoral degree.

3.15 education_main

Categorical. The main field of the civil servant's education, recoded from the raw education credential recorded in the Statskalender, or manually written down during data collection past 2011, into a consolidated set of fields. The raw credentials are mostly Norwegian degree abbreviations (e.g. *c.j.* or *Dr.jur.* for law, *c.oecon.* for economics, *c.polit.* for political science), which are grouped into the following 21 categories: Law; Economics; Political science; Sociology; Psychology; Social work; Business/Management/Finance; Other social science degree; Philosophy/History/Philology; Religion/theology; Other humanities degree; Engineering; Architect; Agronomy; Medicine/Veterinary; Mathematics/Statistics/Bio/Chem/Physics; Other natural science degree; Military and Police; Pedagogics/Teaching/Librarian; Other type of degree/c.mag./utl.e.; and Unclear content degree.

Persons with missing information about degree are coded as Unclear content degree, as it is assumed that all senior bureaucrats have a degree of some kind.

3.16 education_secondary

Categorical. A secondary field of education, where the civil servant holds a second higher education qualification. Note this information may be incomplete. Takes the value NA for persons with only one degree, or where information about degree's are missing.

4 Employment Characteristics

4.1 temporary_employment

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant held the position on a temporary (*konstituert*) basis in this year, 0 otherwise. Where a civil servant was first temporarily appointed and subsequently permanently appointed to the

same position, the entire spell is coded as permanent.

4.2 position_title

Categorical. The civil servant's position title, recoded into one of three categories:

- **Departementsråd** — Permanent Secretary
- **Assisterende departementsråd** — Assistant Permanent Secretary
- **Ekspedisjonssjef** — Director General

Historical title variants (Expeditionschef, Afdelingschef, etc.) have been standardized to their modern equivalents.

4.3 bureaucratic_buffer_i

Categorical. A combined indicator of the civil servant's bureaucratic level (relative to the minister) and position type. It takes three values: "Level-1 (Permanent Secretary)" (a Permanent Secretary, who is the top civil servant directly below the minister), "Level-1 (Director General)" (a Director General directly below the minister, with no Permanent Secretary in the ministry), and "Level-2 (Director General)" (a Director General with a Permanent Secretary sitting between them and the minister). The first two values correspond to `bureaucratic_buffer = 0` and the third to `bureaucratic_buffer = 1`.

4.4 bureaucratic_buffer

Dummy. Coded 1 if there is a Permanent Secretary (*Departementsråd*) in the ministry in that year and the civil servant is not themselves the Permanent Secretary (i.e. a bureaucratic buffer exists between the civil servant and the minister). Coded 0 if the civil servant is the Permanent Secretary, or if no Permanent Secretary exists in the ministry in that year.

4.5 censored

Categorical. Indicates the censoring status of the employment spell:

- **No** — Full information on the spell is available.
- **Left-Censoring** — The civil servant already held the position before the start of the dataset (1884).
- **Right-Censoring** — The civil servant was still in the position at the end of the observation window (31 December 2024). The end date is unknown.

4.6 n_spells

Numeric. The total number of distinct employment spells for the civil servant across the dataset. A new spell begins when there is a gap of one year or more between consecutive observations.

4.7 multiple_spells

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant has more than one distinct employment spell in the dataset (`n_spells > 1`), 0 otherwise.

5 Ministry Characteristics

5.1 ministry

String. The name of the ministry in which the civil servant was employed in the observation year. Names follow the historical names as recorded in the *Statskalenderen* and *Regjeringen.no*.

5.2 department

String. The name of the department (section) within the ministry to which the civil servant was attached. For Permanent Secretaries and Assistant Permanent Secretaries, this field is coded with their position title. For Directors General without department data, this field is coded with the name of the ministry.

5.3 ministry_NSD_ID

Numeric. The NSD ministry code (Sikt, n.d.b).

5.4 ministry_portfolio

Categorical. A continuity-based ministry portfolio label grouping the various ministry names and NSD IDs into a stable policy area over time. The coding scheme defines 23 categories: Ministry of Defense; Ministry of Auditing; Ministry of Transport and Infrastructure; Ministry of Local Government; Ministry of Public Governance; Ministry of Justice; Ministry of Culture; Ministry of Finance; Ministry of Trade and Industry; Ministry of Foreign Affairs; Ministry of Fisheries; Ministry of Health and Social Affairs; Ministry of Oil and Energy; Ministry of Children and Families; Ministry of Agriculture and Food; Ministry of Climate and Environment; Ministry of Education; Ministry of Labor; Minister Without Portfolio; Prime Minister's Office; The Norwegian Council of State Division in Stockholm; Temporary ministries related to world wars; and WWII illegal ministries.

5.5 ministry_creation_year

Numeric. The year in which the ministry (identified by `ministry_NSD_ID`) was created or formally established. Based on Sikt (n.d.b)

5.6 years_since_ministry_creation_year

Numeric. The number of years since the ministry was created, calculated as `year - ministry_creation_year`.

6 Time Period Variables

6.1 decade_start

Numeric. The decade in which the civil servant's employment spell began (e.g. 1880, 1890, ..., 2020), defined as $\lfloor \text{start_year} / 10 \rfloor \times 10$.

6.2 decade

Numeric. The decade of the observation year, defined as $\lfloor \text{year} / 10 \rfloor \times 10$.

6.3 time_period

Categorical. The historical time period of the observation, divided into three sub-periods based on major political-institutional changes in Norway:

- **1884–1940** — From the introduction of parliamentarism until the German occupation.
- **1945–1980** — Post-war reconstruction and the height of social-democratic governance.
- **1981–2024** — The period of welfare state restructuring and New Public Management.

7 Event History Analysis Variables

This section describes variables used to set up discrete-time event history models. The dataset contains **four alternative operationalizations** of employment spells, differing in what counts as the termination of a spell. In all four versions, a spell ends when the civil servant leaves the dataset for a period of at least one year. They differ in whether moves between ministries or between position titles also count as spell endings.

7.1 Employment Spell Identification

7.1.1 `id_spells`

Numeric. A unique identifier for each person–spell combination Operationalization 1 (Main Operationalization). Employment spells start when a person enters a position in the dataset for the first time and stop only when they leave the dataset for a year or more. New employment spells for the same person begin after a gap of at least one year since their last top civil servant position covered by the dataset.

7.1.2 `id_spells2`

Numeric. Spell identifier for Operationalization 2 (spells also terminate when the civil servant changes ministry).

7.1.3 `id_spells3`

Numeric. Spell identifier for Operationalization 3 (spells also terminate when the civil servant changes ministry *and/or* changes position title).

7.1.4 `id_spells4`

Numeric. Spell identifier for Operationalization 4 (spells also terminate when the civil servant changes ministry, position title, *or* department).

7.2 Spell Timing

7.2.1 `start_year / start_year2 / start_year3 / start_year4`

Numeric. The first year of the employment spell in each respective Operationalization. For left-censored spells, this is the year after the start year recorded in the *Statskalenderen*.

7.2.2 `end_year / end_year2 / end_year3 / end_year4`

Numeric. The last year of the employment spell in each respective Operationalization. For right-censored spells this is the last year of the dataset.

7.2.3 `time / time_squared / time_cubed`

Numeric. Duration within the spell for Operationalization 1: `time = year – start_year`. `time_squared` and `time_cubed` are the square and cube of this variable, for modeling non-linear duration dependence.

7.2.4 `start / start2 / start3 / start4`

Numeric. The left endpoint (01.01.YYYY) of the interval for the observation year (in years elapsed since the start of the spell): `start = year - start_year`. Used as the `start` argument in `Surv(start, stop, event)` in R.

7.2.5 `stop / stop2 / stop3 / stop4`

Numeric. The right endpoint (31.12.YYYY) of the interval: `stop = year - start_year + 1`. Used as the `stop` argument in `Surv(start, stop, event)` in R.

7.3 Outcome Variables

7.3.1 `bureaucrat_turnover`

Dummy. The event indicator for Operationalization 1. Coded 1 in the last year of a non-right-censored spell (`year = end_year` and `censored` $\neq$ "Right-Censoring"), 0 otherwise.

7.3.2 `bureaucrat_turnover2`

Dummy. Event indicator for Operationalization 2 (spells also end on ministry change).

7.3.3 `bureaucrat_turnover3`

Dummy. Event indicator for Operationalization 3 (spells also end on ministry change or position title change).

7.3.4 `bureaucrat_turnover4`

Dummy. Event indicator for Operationalization 4 (spells also end on ministry change, position title change, or department change).

7.4 Duration

7.4.1 `duration / duration2 / duration3 / duration4`

Numeric. The total length of the employment spell in years (rounded from days to years using 365.25 days per year), for each respective Operationalization. Calculated as `(end_year - start_year)`. For right-censored spells, this reflects the current observed duration at the end of the observation window.

7.5 Average Turnover

7.5.1 avg_bureaucrat_turnover_year

Numeric. The mean annual turnover rate of top civil servants across all ministries in the observation year. Calculated as the average of `bureaucrat_turnover` across all observations with the same year.

8 Permanent Secretary Variables

8.1 permanent_secretary

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant holds the title of *Departementsråd* (Permanent Secretary), *Departementsråd med spesialoppdrag*, or *Innenriksråd* in the observation year, 0 otherwise.

8.2 PS_in_min

Dummy. Coded 1 if there is a Permanent Secretary present in the civil servant's ministry in the observation year, 0 otherwise. Both the Permanent Secretary themselves and all other senior bureaucrats in that ministry receive a 1.

8.3 y_since_PS_in_min

Numeric range from -77 to 101 . The number of years since the first year a Permanent Secretary was employed in a ministry (ministries are defined using `ministry_NSD_ID`). Zero in the year of introduction, positive afterward, and negative in years before it (the negative values measuring how long before the introduction the observation falls). Missing for ministries in which no Permanent Secretary is ever employed.

8.4 time_period_since_PS_in_min

Categorical. A categorized version of `y_since_PS_in_min` that groups the years before and after the introduction of a Permanent Secretary to the civil servant's ministry into 15-year bands. Positive codes cover the period from the introduction onward, and zero or negative codes the period before it:

- **3** — 30 or more years after the introduction ($y_since_PS_in_min \geq 30$).
- **2** — 15 to 29 years after ($15 \leq y_since_PS_in_min < 30$).
- **1** — 0 to 14 years after ($0 \leq y_since_PS_in_min < 15$), i.e. the first 15 years including the year of introduction.
- **0** — 1 to 19 years before ($-20 < y_since_PS_in_min < 0$).
- **-1** — 20 to 39 years before ($-40 < y_since_PS_in_min \leq -20$).

- -2 — 40 or more years before ($y_since_PS_in_min \leq -40$).

Missing where $y_since_PS_in_min$ is missing (ministries that never had a Permanent Secretary).

9 State Secretary and Political Advisor Variables

These variables capture information about the political appointees (state secretaries and political advisors [*politiske rådgivere*]) in the civil servant's ministry.

9.1 `state_secretaries_NSDID`

Dummy. Coded 1 if there was at least one state secretary (*statssekretær*) in the ministry in the observation year, 0 otherwise. This is the variable used as the “Political Amplifier” variable in the paper.

9.2 `state_secretaries_NSDID_cat`

Categorical. A three-category elaboration of `state_secretaries_NSDID`:

- **State Secretaries in Ministry** — at least one state secretary present (`state_secretaries_NSDID = 1`).
- **Vacant** — no state secretary that year, but state secretaries had already been introduced in the ministry (the position exists but is unfilled that year).
- **Not Implemented** — no state secretary, observation is in a year before state secretaries were introduced in the ministry.

9.3 `y_since_state_secretaries_law`

Numeric. The number of years since the introduction of the 1947 law institutionalizing state secretaries (*statssekretærordningen*). Negative values for observations before 1947.

9.4 `y_since_state_secretaries_NSDID`

Numeric. The number of years since the first state secretary was appointed in the specific ministry.

9.5 `after_state_secretaries_NSDID`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the observation year is after the first state secretary was appointed in a ministry.

9.6 `after_political_appointees_NSDID`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the observation year is after the first political appointee (state secretary or political advisor) was appointed in the ministry.

9.7 after_poladv_NSDID

Dummy. Coded 1 if the observation year is after the first political advisor (*politisk rådgiver*) was appointed in the ministry.

9.8 statesec_NSD_ID_share_posts_start_of_year / statesec_NSD_ID_n_posts_start_of_year

Numeric. The share and count, respectively, of state secretary positions in the ministry at the start of the observation year.

9.9 statesec_NSD_ID_share_party_cross_start_of_year / statesec_NSD_ID_n_party_cross_start_of_year

Numeric. The share and count of state secretaries in the ministry who come from a different party than the ministry's minister, at the start of the year.

9.10 statesec_NSD_ID_share_posts_end_of_year / statesec_NSD_ID_n_posts_end_of_year

The share and count, respectively, of state secretary positions in the ministry at the end of the observation year.

9.11 statesec_NSD_ID_share_party_cross_end_of_year / statesec_NSD_ID_n_party_cross_end_of_year

Numeric. The share and count of state secretaries in the ministry who come from a different party than the ministry's minister, at the end of the observation year.

9.12 poladv_NSD_ID_share_posts_start_of_year / poladv_NSD_ID_n_posts_start_of_year

Numeric. The share and count of political advisor (*politisk rådgiver*) positions in the ministry at the start of the year.

9.13 poladv_NSD_ID_share_party_cross_start_of_year / poladv_NSD_ID_n_party_cross_start_of_year

Numeric. The share and count of political advisors in the ministry who come from a different party than the ministry's minister, at the start of the year.

9.14 poladv_NSD_ID_share_posts_end_of_year /
poladv_NSD_ID_n_posts_end_of_year

Numeric. The share and count of political advisor (*politisk rådgiver*) positions in the ministry at the end of the observation year.

9.15 poladv_NSD_ID_share_party_cross_end_of_year /
poladv_NSD_ID_n_party_cross_end_of_year

Numeric. The share and count of political advisors in the ministry who come from a different party than the ministry's minister, at the end of the observation year.

9.16 poladv_NSDID

Dummy. Coded 1 if there was at least one political advisor (*politisk rådgiver*) in the civil servant's ministry in the observation year, 0 otherwise.

9.17 poladv_NSDID_cat

Categorical. A three-category elaboration of poladv_NSDID: Political Advisors in Ministry (at least one present), Vacant (none that year, but political advisors had already been introduced in the ministry), and Not Implemented (none, before political advisors were introduced in the ministry).

9.18 y_since_poladv_NSDID

Numeric. The number of years since the first political advisor was appointed in the civil servant's ministry.

10 Government Turnover Variables

Government turnover is coded based on the departures of governments (*regjeringer*) that lasted more than 90 days. All government turnover variables are measured at the year level (i.e. the same value for all civil servants in a given year). **Note:** The years 1940 and 1945 are treated as government turnover years due to the German occupation and liberation, respectively. Although the Norwegian government in office in 1940 continued to govern in exile until 1945, civil servants in Norway were under the control of German-appointed governments during this period.

10.1 election_year

Dummy. Coded 1 if a parliamentary election was held in the observation year, 0 otherwise.

10.2 GOV_turnover

Dummy. Coded 1 if there was a change in the party of the Prime Minister during the observation year. Coded 0 otherwise.

10.3 GOV_turnover_any_change

Dummy. Coded 1 for every year in which *any* government change (of any type) occurred.

10.4 GOV_turnover_new_PM

Dummy. Coded 1 if a new Prime Minister (regardless of party) took office during the observation year.

10.5 GOV_turnover_new_Parties

Dummy. Coded 1 if the coalition composition changed during the observation year (i.e. a party joined or left the coalition).

10.6 GOV_turnover_during_term

Dummy. Coded 1 if a government change (change in PM party) occurred *outside* of an election year (i.e. a mid-term change of government).

10.7 GOV_turnover_election

Dummy. Coded 1 if a government change (change in PM party) occurred *following* a parliamentary election.

10.8 GOV_turnover_lagged

Dummy. The value of GOV_turnover in the previous year ($\text{year} - 1$).

10.9 GOV_turnover_lead

Dummy. The value of GOV_turnover in the following year ($\text{year} + 1$).

10.10 worked_for_multiple_governments

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant experienced at least one government turnover ($\text{GOV_turnover} = 1$) during their employment spell (Operationalization 1). Coded NA for left-censored spells.

10.11 years_since_last_turnover

Numeric. In a government turnover year (`GOV_turnover` = 1), the number of years the *previous* government had been in office, i.e. the gap between this turnover and the one before it (the length of the government spell that just ended). Coded 0 in all non-turnover years.

10.12 years_since_last_turnover_2

Numeric. The same quantity as `years_since_last_turnover` — the number of years the *previous* government was in office — but assigned to every year within the incoming government's spell rather than only to the turnover year. It thus records, throughout the current government's time in office, how long the government that preceded it had lasted.

10.13 years_since_last_turnover_2_categories

Categorical. A categorized version of `years_since_last_turnover_2`, banding the length of the previous government:

- **Short (0–4)** — the previous government was in office for fewer than 5 years.
- **Long (5–8)** — the previous government was in office for 5 to 8 years.
- **Very long (9–20)** — the previous government was in office for 9 or more years (the maximum observed is 20).

10.14 FirstPM

Dummy. Coded 1 if the year marks the first time the PM's party has held the office of Prime Minister. Coded 0 otherwise.

11 Minister Turnover Variables

These variables measure turnover at the *ministry* level, capturing whether the individual minister responsible for the civil servant's ministry changed during the year.

11.1 minister_turnover

Dummy. Coded 1 if there was a change of minister in the civil servant's ministry during the observation year that was *not* caused by a government turnover (i.e. a within-government minister change). Coded 0 otherwise.

Note: Minister changes during years of government turnover are captured by `GOV_turnover` instead.

11.2 minister_turnover_lagged

Dummy. The value of `minister_turnover` for the previous year.

11.3 minister_turnover_lead

Dummy. The value of `minister_turnover` for the following year.

12 Minister Characteristics

These variables describe the minister(s) responsible for the civil servant's ministry. Most are available in two versions: **start of year** (the minister in office on 1 January) and **end of year** (the minister in office on 31 December). These variables are identical if there was no change of minister in a ministry j in year t .

12.1 minister_NSD_Person_ID_start_of_year / minister_NSD_Person_ID_end_of_year

Numeric. NSD person identifier for the minister at the start/end of the year.

12.2 minister_first_name_last_name_year_born_start_of_year / minister_first_name_last_name_year_born_end_of_year

String. Concatenated identifier (first name + last name + birth year) for the minister at the start/end of the year.

12.3 minister_party_long_start_of_year / minister_party_long_end_of_year

String. The party affiliation of the minister at the start/end of the year (full party name).

12.4 minister_gender_start_of_year / minister_gender_end_of_year

Dummy. Gender of the minister: 0 = man, 1 = woman.

12.5 minister_age_year_start_of_year / minister_age_year_end_of_year

Numeric. Age of the minister in the observation year.

12.6 minister_age_at_start_start_of_year /
minister_age_at_start_end_of_year

Numeric. Age of the minister when they first took office in the ministry.

12.7 minister_in_office_before_start_of_year /
minister_in_office_before_end_of_year

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister had previously held ministerial office (in any ministry) before this spell.

12.8 minister_not_in_office_before_start_of_year /
minister_not_in_office_before_end_of_year

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister is in their first year of ministerial office (in this ministry) and has not held ministerial office before.

12.9 minister_previous_experience_days_start_of_year /
minister_previous_experience_days_end_of_year

Numeric. Total number of days the minister previously served in any ministerial position before the current spell.

12.10 minister_time_in_dep_start_of_year /
minister_time_in_dep_end_of_year

Numeric. The number of years the minister has been in office in this specific ministry (year – start year in this ministry).

12.11 minister_parliament_earliest_start_of_year /
minister_parliament_earliest_end_of_year

Date. The earliest date on which the minister was a member of parliament (*Stortinget*).

12.12 minister_parliament_before_start_of_year /
minister_parliament_before_end_of_year

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister had parliamentary experience before taking office.

12.13 `minister_state.secretary_earliest_start_of_year /`
`minister_state.secretary_earliest_end_of_year`

Date. The earliest date on which the minister served as a state secretary.

12.14 `minister_state.secretary_before_start_of_year /`
`minister_state.secretary_before_end_of_year`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister had served as a state secretary before becoming minister.

12.15 `minister_political.advisor_earliest_start_of_year /`
`minister_political.advisor_earliest_end_of_year`

Date. The earliest date on which the minister served as a political advisor.

12.16 `minister_political.advisor_before_start_of_year /`
`minister_political.advisor_before_end_of_year`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister had served as a political advisor before becoming minister.

12.17 `minister_national.political.experience.start_start_of_year /`
`minister_national.political.experience.start_end_of_year`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister had any national political experience (minister, parliament, state secretary, or political advisor role) before taking ministerial office.

12.18 `minister_experience_start_of_year / minister_experience_end_of_year`

Numeric. The number of years the minister has served as a minister in total (across all spells and ministries) up to and including the observation year.

12.19 `minister_party_first_office_year`

Numeric. The first year the minister's party held government office.

12.20 `minister_party_first_office`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the observation year is the first year the minister's party holds government office.

12.21 `minister_party_share_posts_start_of_year /`
`minister_party_share_posts_end_of_year`

Numeric. The proportion of all cabinet posts held by the minister's party at the start/end of the observation year.

12.22 `minister_party_n_posts_start_of_year /`
`minister_party_n_posts_end_of_year`

Numeric. The number of cabinet posts held by the minister's party at the start/end of the year.

12.23 `minister_from_PM_party_start_of_year /`
`minister_from_PM_party_end_of_year`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister in the civil servant's ministry belongs to the Prime Minister's party.

12.24 `minister_party_time_since_last_office`

Numeric. The number of years since the minister's party last held government office.

12.25 `minister_party_time_since_last_office_first_as_max`

Numeric. The number of years since the minister's party last held government office, but for parties that have never previously held office, the value is set to the historical maximum observed value rather than NA.

12.26 `minister_party_more_than_two_periodes_since_office`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister's party has been out of government for more than two parliamentary terms (approximately 8 years or more).

13 Ideological Match Variables

These variables measure the alignment between the political party(ies) of the government that *appointed* (was in office when the civil servant took the position) and the government that is currently in power.

13.1 `match_start_end_PMparty`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the Prime Minister's party at the start of the civil servant's spell is the same as the PM's party at the end of the year (i.e. the same party appointed and is currently overseeing this civil servant).

13.2 match_start_end_party

Dummy. Coded 1 if the party of the minister at the start of the civil servant's spell is the same as the minister's party at the end of the observation year.

13.3 match_start_end_left_right

Dummy. Coded 1 if the left-right ideological alignment of the government at the start of the civil servant's spell matches the ideological alignment of the current government (see `government_left_right_gov_end_of_year` for coding).

13.4 match_start_end_coalition_party

Dummy. Coded 1 if the party of the minister at the start of the spell is part of the current governing coalition.

13.5 match_party_long_end_PMparty

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant's own party affiliation (`party_long`) matches the PM's party at the end of the observation year.

13.6 match_party_long_end_party

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant's party affiliation matches the party of the minister at the end of the observation year.

13.7 appointed_by_own_party

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant's own party (`party_long`) was among the parties in government at the start of their employment spell (Operationalization 1) — i.e. they were appointed under a government that included their own party — and 0 otherwise. Coded NA for civil servants with no party affiliation.

13.8 share_under_hiring_party

Numeric. The proportion of the civil servant's spell spent under a minister from the same party as the minister that appointed the civil servant.

13.9 share_under_hiring_PMparty

Numeric. The proportion of the civil servant's spell spent under a Prime Minister from the same party as when the civil servant was first appointed.

13.10 share_under_hiring_coalition_party

Numeric. The proportion of the civil servant's spell spent under a government in which the civil servant's appointing party is part of.

13.11 share_under_hiring_left_right

Numeric. The proportion of the civil servant's spell spent under a government of the same left–right ideological bloc as when the civil servant was first appointed.

14 Government-Level Variables

These variables describe the government in office during the observation year. Two versions are available: **start of year** (the government in office on 1 January) and **end of year** (the government in office on 31 December).

14.1 government_PMparty_end_of_year / government_PMparty_start_of_year

String. The party of the Prime Minister at the end/start of the observation year.

14.2 government_left_right_gov_end_of_year / government_left_right_gov_start_of_year

Categorical. Left–right classification of the government at the end/start of the observation year: Left (social-democratic) or Right (conservative). Governments led by the Labor Party (*Arbeiderpartiet*) are coded Left; governments led by the Liberal Party (*Venstre*) are also coded Left until 1935, as the Liberals were the principal left party until the first lasting Labor government in 1935, with the Conservatives being the right party. From 1935 onward the Liberals and Conservatives belong to the same conservative bloc. All other governments in Norway are coded as Right.

14.3 government_percent_parliament_end_of_year / government_percent_parliament_start_of_year

Numeric. The proportion of parliamentary seats held by the governing party or coalition at the end/start of the year.

14.4 government_type_end_of_year / government_type_start_of_year

Categorical. The type of government:

- **Single-Party Majority Government**

- **Single-Party Minority Government**
- **Multi-Party Coalition Minimum-Winning Majority Government**
- **Multi-Party Coalition Oversized Majority Government**
- **Multi-Party Coalition Minority Government**

14.5 `government_single_party_end_of_year / government_single_party_start_of_year`

Categorical. Single-Party or Multi-Party.

14.6 `government_minority_end_of_year / government_minority_start_of_year`

Categorical. Minority or Majority.

14.7 `government_n_ministers_start_of_year /
government_n_ministers_end_of_year`

Numeric. Total number of ministers in the government at the start/end of the year.

14.8 `government_PMparty_share_posts_start_of_year /
government_PMparty_share_posts_end_of_year`

Numeric. The share of cabinet posts held by the Prime Minister's party at the start/end of the year.

14.9 `government_time_since_party_last_PM`

Numeric. Measured at government turnover years ($GOV_turnover = 1$): the number of years since the incoming Prime Minister's party last held the office of Prime Minister — that is, the length of the party's spell out of the premiership before returning to it. Coded 0 in non-turnover years, and 0 the first time a party takes the premiership (no previous spell to measure from).

14.10 `government_time_since_party_last_PM_first_as_max`

Numeric. The same as `government_time_since_party_last_PM`, except that when a party holds the premiership for the first time (no previous spell), the value is set to the historical maximum observed gap rather than left undefined. Outside turnover years it is 0.

14.11 `government_more_than_two_periodes_since_office`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the governing party has been out of office for more than two parliamentary terms (≥ 8 years).

14.12 government_ENoP_cabinetseats_end_of_year /
government_ENoP_cabinetseats_start_of_year

Numeric. Effective number of parties in the government, calculated using the Laakso-Taagepera formula.

14.13 government_ENoP_parliament_end_of_year /
government_ENoP_parliament_start_of_year

Numeric. Effective number of parties in the government, calculated using the Laakso-Taagepera formula based on *parliamentary seat shares* of governing parties.

14.14 government_parties_start_of_year /
government_parties_end_of_year

String. A comma-separated list of the parties in government at the start/end of the year.

14.15 government_n_statesec_start_of_year /
government_n_statesec_end_of_year

Numeric. The total number of state secretaries across all ministries at the start/end of the year.

14.16 government_n_party_cross_statesec_start_of_year /
government_n_party_cross_statesec_end_of_year

Numeric. The total number of state secretaries across all ministries who serve a minister from a different party than their own party.

14.17 government_share_party_cross_statesec_start_of_year /
government_share_party_cross_statesec_end_of_year

Numeric. The share of state secretaries across all ministries who serve a minister from a different party than their own party.

14.18 government_n_poladv_start_of_year /
government_n_poladv_end_of_year

Numeric. The total number of political advisors across all ministries at the start/end of the year.

14.19 `government_n_party_cross_poladv_start_of_year /`
`government_n_party_cross_poladv_end_of_year`

Numeric. The number of political advisors in the government who are from a different party than the minister in their ministry.

14.20 `government_share_party_cross_poladv_start_of_year /`
`government_share_party_cross_poladv_end_of_year`

Numeric. The share of political advisors in the government who are from a different party than the minister in their ministry.

15 Parliamentary Variables

15.1 `parliament_n`

Numeric. The total number of members of parliament (*Stortingsrepresentanter*) in the parliamentary term covering the observation year.

15.2 `parliament_effective_parties_end_of_year /`
`parliament_effective_parties_start_of_year`

Numeric. The effective number of parties in parliament (Laakso–Taagepera index based on seat shares) at the end/start of the observation year.

15.3 `parliament_minister_N_party_end_of_year /`
`parliament_minister_N_party_start_of_year`

Numeric. The number of parliamentary seats held by the minister's party in the parliament at the end/start of the year.

15.4 `parliament_minister_party_share_end_of_year /`
`parliament_minister_party_share_start_of_year`

Numeric. The share of parliamentary seats held by the minister's party at the end/start of the year.

15.5 `parliament_PMparty_party_share_end_of_year /`
`parliament_PMparty_party_share_start_of_year`

Numeric. The share of parliamentary seats held by the Prime Minister's party at the end/start of the year.

16 Ministry-Level Staffing Variables

16.1 `ministry_multiple_L1`

Dummy. Coded 1 if there is more than one civil servant at the highest bureaucratic level (directly below the minister) in the civil servant's ministry in the observation year.

16.2 `ministry_L1_n`

Numeric. The number of civil servants at the highest bureaucratic level (directly below the minister) in the civil servant's ministry in the observation year.

16.3 `ministry_L1_n_categorical`

Categorical. A categorized version of `ministry_L1_n`: 1 TCS, 2-5 TCS, 6-9 TCS, 10+ TCS.

16.4 `ministry_multiple_senior_bureaucrats`

Dummy. Coded 1 if there is more than one top civil servant (of any position title) in the civil servant's ministry in the observation year.

16.5 `ministry_senior_bureaucrats_n`

Numeric. The total number of top civil servants in the civil servant's ministry in the observation year.

16.6 `ministry_senior_bureaucrats_n_categorical`

Categorical. A categorized version of `ministry_senior_bureaucrats_n`: 1 TCS, 2-5 TCS, 6-9 TCS, 10+ TCS.

16.7 `ministries_n_employees`

Numeric. The number of employees in the civil servant's ministry in the observation year.

17 Top Civil Servant Career Variables

17.1 `political_career`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant held any of the following elected or appointed political offices at any point in their career — whether before *or* after the observation year — and 0 otherwise: minister, member of parliament, state secretary, political advisor, or local politician (the latter only from 1970 onward). It is the union of `office_any_before` and `office_any_after`, so a civil servant who only later entered political office is

also coded 1. The underlying offices record positions *held*, not unsuccessful candidacies; parliamentary experience excludes deputy representatives (*vararepresentanter*), and local-political experience is also restricted to candidates who won a seat in regional or municipal elections.

17.2 DG_before

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant previously held a top civil servant position (Director General or equivalent) in *any* ministry before the current observation.

17.3 DG_same_ministry_before

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant previously held a top civil servant position in the *same* ministry before the current observation.

17.4 office_minister_before / office_minister_after

Dummy. *office_minister_before*: coded 1 if the civil servant had served as a minister before this observation year. *office_minister_after*: coded 1 if the civil servant later served as a minister after this observation year.

17.5 office_minister_career

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant served as a minister at any point in their career.

17.6 office_minister_time_since_first

Numeric. The number of years since the civil servant first held a ministerial post, relative to the observation year. Negative values indicate years before the civil servant's first ministerial appointment.

17.7 office_parliament_before / office_parliament_after / office_parliament_career

Dummy variables. As above but for membership of parliament (*Stortinget*).

17.8 office_parliament_time_since_first

Numeric. Years since the civil servant first became a member of parliament, relative to the observation year.

17.9 office_statesec_before / office_statesec_after / office_statesec_career

Dummy variables. As above but for holding the position of state secretary.

17.10 office_statesec_time_since_first

Numeric. Years since the civil servant first became a state secretary.

17.11 office_polrad_before / office_polrad_after / office_polrad_career

Dummy variables. As above but for holding the position of political advisor (*politisk rådgiver*).

17.12 office_polrad_time_since_first

Numeric. Years since the civil servant first became a political advisor.

17.13 office_loc_pol_after1970_before / office_loc_pol_after1970_after / office_loc_pol_after1970_career

Dummy variables. Whether the civil servant served as a *local politician*, defined as having won a seat in a Norwegian municipal (*kommunestyre*) or county/regional (*fylkesting*) election. Identified by matching to the Local Candidate Dataset (Fiva, Sørensen & Vølle, 2024), retaining only those candidates elected to a local or regional seat; candidates who ran but were not elected are excluded. Because the dataset covers elections from 1971 onward, this experience is observed only from approximately 1970 (hence the variable name). *_before* is coded 1 if the civil servant's first local/regional electoral win predates the observation year, *_after* if it falls in or after the observation year, and *_career* if it occurs at any point.

17.14 office_loc_pol_after1970_time_since_first

Numeric. Years since the civil servant first held a local political office.

17.15 office_any_before

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant held *any* of the above political offices before the observation year.

17.16 office_any_after

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant held any of the above political offices after the observation year.

17.17 office_any_only_after

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant held a political office *only after* the observation year (never before).

17.18 next_position_sector

Categorical. The sector of the civil servant's next position after leaving the top civil servant post. Coded only for civil servants who left office after 2011 (exit destinations were collected when data were extended to cover top civil servants after the government ceased publishing the yearly government employee register *Statskalenderen*); NA for all other observations. The categories are:

- **Central Administration (Ministries)** — a position in a ministry.
- **Central Administration (Ministries: Special Advisor)** — a special advisor (*spesialrådgiver*) post within a ministry.
- **Central Administration (Agencies)** — a position in a central administration agency
- **Central Administration (Foreign Service)** — a position in the foreign service (e.g. ambassador or other diplomatic posting).
- **Local Administration** — a position in municipal or county/regional administration.
- **State-Owned Enterprises** — a position in a state-owned company.
- **Private Sector** — a position in the private sector.
- **Nonprofit Sector** — a position in a non-profit organization, interest group, or foundation.
- **International Organization** — a position in an international organization.
- **Politics** — a move into elected or appointed political office.
- **Retirement** — the civil servant retired.
- **Dead** — the civil servant died in or shortly after leaving office.

18 Pension Age Variables

18.1 pension_age_year

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant reaches age 70 (the mandatory pension age for senior civil servants) during the observation year ($\text{age_year} = 70$); coded 0 otherwise.

18.2 pension_age

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant is 70 years or older in year t ; otherwise, coded 0.

18.3 pension_age_propensity_age_year

Numeric. The number of years until the civil servant reaches mandatory pension age, calculated as $70 - \text{age_year}$. Negative values indicate the civil servant has passed the mandatory pension age.

18.4 pension_age_propensity_age_at_start

Numeric. The number of years until mandatory pension age at the *start* of the employment spell, calculated as $70 - \text{age_at_start}$.

19 Historical Period Variables

19.1 post_1906

Dummy. Coded 1 if $\text{year} > 1905$ (after the dissolution of the union between Norway and Sweden).

19.2 WWI

Dummy. Coded 1 if the observation year falls within the First World War (1914–1918).

19.3 WWII

Dummy. Coded 1 if the observation year falls within the Second World War (1940–1945).

19.4 post_WWII

Dummy. Coded 1 if the observation year is after the Second World War ($\text{year} > 1945$).

19.5 post_SLS

Dummy. Coded 1 if the observation year is 1991 or later, corresponding to the period after the introduction of the Senior Civil Service reform (*Statens Lederlønssystem*, SLS) in Norway.

19.6 org_change

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant moves to a different ministry in the following year within the same employment spell (i.e. ministry_NSD_ID at time $t \neq \text{ministry_NSD_ID}$ at time $t + 1$ for the same spell identifier). Coded 0 otherwise.

19.7 dep_end

Dummy. Coded 1 if the civil servant's ministry is dissolved or merged in the following year (i.e. the ministry does not appear in the dataset in year $t + 1$ and the last year of the ministry is before the end of the observation window).

Part II

Governments: Governments_NOR

20 About the Dataset

The Governments_NOR dataset contains information about each Norwegian government during the period covered by the project. The dataset describes the political environment at the government level and is one of the source datasets used to construct the government-level variables in TCS_NOR (see Section 10 and the government-level variables in Part I).

The dataset is structured at the cabinet-spell level, counting a new cabinet when the prime minister is replaced, when one or more parties join or leave the government, and after elections. Each row is one such government (cabinet).

21 Identification, Type, and Composition

21.1 government

String. The name of the government (the surname of the Prime Minister). A roman numeral distinguishes non-consecutive governments led by the same Prime Minister with a different Prime Minister in between (e.g. “Stoltenberg II”).

21.2 version

String. A version label for the government. Consecutive governments under the same Prime Minister whose parliamentary basis changes (e.g. a party joins or leaves) are distinguished by letters (A, B, C, ...). A new version is recorded when the government composition changes (due to a party joining or leaving, while the prime minister remains the same) or when the government wins an election and continues. Missing for governments that saw no such change

21.3 government_version

String. A combined label uniquely identifying each government version (the government name together with its version). This is the variable that links to government_version in the Ministers_NOR dataset.

21.4 government_type

Categorical. The type of government, in four categories:

- **Single-Party Majority** — one party holding a parliamentary majority.
- **Multi-Party Majority** — a coalition holding a parliamentary majority (combining minimum-winning and oversized coalitions).
- **Single-Party Minority** — one party without a parliamentary majority.
- **Multi-Party Minority** — a coalition without a parliamentary majority.

21.5 government_left_right

Categorical. Left–right classification of the government: `Left` (social-democratic) or `Right` (conservative). Governments led by the Labor Party (*Arbeiderpartiet*) are coded `Left`; governments led by the Liberal Party (*Venstre*) are also coded `Left` until 1935, as the Liberals were the principal left party until the first lasting Labor government in 1935, with the Conservatives being the right party. From 1935 onward the Liberals and Conservatives belong to the same conservative bloc. All other governments in Norway are coded as `Right`.

21.6 coalition_government

Dummy. Coded 1 if the government is a multi-party coalition, 0 if it is a single-party government.

21.7 minority_government

Dummy. Coded 1 if the government is a minority government, 0 if it is a majority government.

21.8 parties_long

String. The full names of the parties participating in the government.

21.9 PM

String. The name of the Prime Minister.

21.10 PM_party

String. The full name of the Prime Minister's party.

21.11 share_of_parliament

Numeric. The share of parliamentary seats held by the governing party or coalition.

22 Timing and Duration

22.1 start_date

Date (YYYY-MM-DD). The date on which the government took office.

22.2 stop_date

Date (YYYY-MM-DD). The date on which the government left office.

22.3 stop_reason

Categorical. The reason the government left office:

- **Continued after election** — the government continued in office following an election.
- **Election loss** — the government left office following an election.
- **No confidence** — the government fell on a confidence vote (including votes of no confidence, cabinet questions, and negative majorities).
- **No confidence/Conflict with the King** — a vote of confidence arising from a dispute between the government and the monarch regarding the government's resignation.
- **Prime Minister's retirement** — the Prime Minister stepped down.
- **Prime Minister's death** — the Prime Minister died in office.
- **Coalition dissent** — the government fell due to disagreement between the governing parties.
- **Coalition expansion** — the government was reconstituted by expanding the coalition.
- **Defeat in referendum** — the government left office following a referendum defeat.
- **German occupation** — the government left office due to the German WWII-occupation.
- **NA** — the currently sitting government, for which no exit reason is recorded.

22.4 days_in_office

Numeric. The number of days the government was in office.

22.5 days_in_office_same_PM

Numeric. The number of days served continuously under the same Prime Minister (from the earliest start to the latest exit across version changes under that Prime Minister).

22.6 `days_in_office_same_parties`

Numeric. The number of days served continuously with the same party composition, reflecting the duration during which the governing parties remained unchanged, irrespective of changes in the Prime Minister.

23 Aggregated Minister Characteristics

These variables summarize the characteristics of the government's ministers, aggregated from the `Ministers_NOR` dataset and measured at the start of the government. "Before" refers to experience a minister had acquired before taking office in the government.

23.1 `ministers_avg_age`

Numeric. The mean age of the government's ministers at the time the government took office.

23.2 `ministers_share_female`

Numeric. The proportion of women among the government's ministers.

23.3 `ministers_share_parliament_before`

Numeric. The share of the government's ministers with prior parliamentary experience.

23.4 `ministers_share_state_secretary_before`

Numeric. The share of the government's ministers with prior experience as a state secretary.

23.5 `ministers_share_political_advisor_before`

Numeric. The share of the government's ministers with prior experience as a political advisor (in the ministries).

23.6 `ministers_share_minister_before`

Numeric. The share of the government's ministers with prior experience as a minister.

23.7 `ministers_share_national_politics_before`

Numeric. The share of the government's ministers with any prior national political experience (parliament, state secretary, or political advisor).

Part III

Ministers: Ministers_NOR

24 About the Ministers_NOR Dataset

The Ministers_NOR dataset contains information about Norwegian ministers and their appointments. The dataset describes the political environment at the minister level and is one of the source datasets used to construct the minister-level variables in TCS_NOR (see the minister characteristics in Part I).

The dataset is structured at the ministerial-post level. A new row begins whenever a new government takes office or a minister's title changes — when they move to a different ministry, when their portfolio or its name changes, or when they temporarily take on an additional ministry alongside their own. This follows from the dataset being based on Sikt's Data on the political system (Sikt, n.d.a). Each row is one such post. The dataset also carries variables that regroup these posts into *complete spells* — the continuous time from a minister's appointment to their exit from cabinet, regardless of any title changes in between (see `spell_number` and `start_complete_spell_date` below).

25 Identification and Personal Characteristics

25.1 ID

Numeric. A unique identifier for each individual minister *within this dataset* (a person retains the same ID across their appointments in Ministers_NOR).

25.2 NSD_Person_ID

Numeric. The NSD (Norwegian Centre for Research Data) person identifier (Sikt, n.d.a)

25.3 NSD_full_name

String. The minister's full name (first name followed by last name) as it appears in Sikt (n.d.a) for ministers until 2022, based on Regjeringen.no after 2022.

25.4 last_name

String. The minister's last name.

25.5 first_name

String. The minister's first name.

25.6 year_born

Numeric. The minister's year of birth.

25.7 year_died

Numeric. The minister's year of death. Missing for ministers who are still living.

25.8 gender

Dummy. Gender of the minister: 0 = man, 1 = woman.

25.9 first_name_last_name_year_born

String. A concatenation of first name, last name, and year of birth. This is the key used to link the same person across the datasets (see Section 1.1.1).

25.10 party_long

String. The full name of the minister's party.

26 Appointment and Ministry

26.1 start_date

Date (YYYY-MM-DD). The date on which the minister was appointed to the post.

26.2 stop_date

Date (YYYY-MM-DD). The date on which the minister was dismissed from the post.

26.3 days_in_office

Numeric. The length of the appointment in days (`stop_date - start_date`).

26.4 age_at_start

Numeric. The minister's age at the start of the appointment.

26.5 `ministry`

String. The name of the ministry to which the minister was appointed.

26.6 `ministry_NSD_ID`

Numeric. The NSD ministry code, enabling linkage with the ministry identifiers in TCS_NOR and POLADV_NOR.

26.7 `ministry_portfolio`

Categorical. A continuity-based ministry portfolio label grouping the various ministry codes into a stable policy area over time. The coding scheme defines 23 categories: Ministry of Defense; Ministry of Auditing; Ministry of Transport and Infrastructure; Ministry of Local Government; Ministry of Public Governance; Ministry of Justice; Ministry of Culture; Ministry of Finance; Ministry of Trade and Industry; Ministry of Foreign Affairs; Ministry of Fisheries; Ministry of Health and Social Affairs; Ministry of Oil and Energy; Ministry of Children and Families; Ministry of Agriculture and Food; Ministry of Climate and Environment; Ministry of Education; Ministry of Labor; Minister Without Portfolio; Prime Minister's Office; The Norwegian Council of State Division in Stockholm; Temporary ministries related to world wars; and WWII illegal ministries.

26.8 `minister_title_NSD`

String. The minister's official title as recorded in the NSD source data or on Regjeringen.no.

26.9 `temporary_employment`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister held the post on a temporary basis, identified from titles beginning with *Konstituert*, *Fungerende*, or *Bestyrende*; 0 otherwise.

26.10 `temporary_two_ministerial_posts`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister simultaneously held a second ministerial post during this appointment (an overlapping appointment that begins after, and ends before, the current one), 0 otherwise.

27 Spells and Ministerial Experience

A *spell* groups together consecutive ministerial appointments held without a break (a gap of no more than one day between the end of one appointment and the start of the next), including periods in which the minister held two posts at once. For ministers still in office, durations are computed up to the data cut-off date.

27.1 `start_complete_spell_date`

Date. The start date of the complete spell (the first appointment in a run of consecutive appointments).

27.2 `stop_complete_spell_date`

Date. The end date of the complete spell (the last appointment in a run of consecutive appointments).

27.3 `spell_number`

Numeric. The sequential number of the spell for this minister (1 for the first spell, 2 for the second, etc.), ordered by date.

27.4 `n_spells_total`

Numeric. The total number of distinct (non-consecutive) spells the minister has across the dataset (the maximum `spell_number` for that minister).

27.5 `days_in_office_spell`

Numeric. The total length of the complete spell in days (`stop_complete_spell_date` – `start_complete_spell_date`).

27.6 `spell_days_of_previous_ministerial_experience_at_start`

Numeric. The number of days of prior ministerial experience the minister had accumulated at the start of the current spell, computed as the cumulative sum of the lengths of all earlier spells. Coded 0 for a minister's first spell.

27.7 `total_days_of_ministerial_experience`

Numeric. The total number of days of ministerial experience the minister accumulated across their entire career (the sum of all spell lengths).

27.8 `parliament_before`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister's appointment began after their earliest date as a member of parliament (*Stortinget*), i.e. they had parliamentary experience before this appointment; 0 otherwise.

27.9 `minister_before`

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister had accumulated prior ministerial experience (`spell_days_of_previous_ministerial_experience_at_start` > 0) before the start of the appointment,

0 otherwise.

27.10 polrad_before

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister's appointment began after their earliest date as a political advisor (*politisk rådgiver*), i.e. they had political advisor experience before this appointment; 0 otherwise.

27.11 statesec_before

Dummy. Coded 1 if the minister's appointment began on or after their earliest date as a state secretary, i.e. they had state secretary experience before this appointment; 0 otherwise.

28 Government Identification Variables

28.1 government

String. The name of the government in which the minister served (links to `government` in `Governments_NOR`).

28.2 version

Numeric. The version of the government (links to `version` in `Governments_NOR`).

28.3 government_version

String. The combined government-version label (links to `government_version` in `Governments_NOR`).

Part IV

State Secretaries and Political Advisors:

POLADV_NOR

29 About the POLADV_NOR Dataset

The POLADV_NOR dataset contains information about Norwegian state secretaries (*statssekretærer*) and political advisors (*politiske rådgivere*) and their appointments. The dataset describes the political environment at the level of political appointees and is one of the source datasets used to construct the state secretary and political advisor variables in TCS_NOR.

The records were scraped from Regjeringen.no (Regjeringen, 2025) and parsed into the variables below; the appointee's party, NSD identifiers, and ministry were then added by matching to the Sikt data.

The dataset is structured at the appointment level: one row per appointment as a state secretary or political advisor. Every state secretary and political advisor is attached to a specific minister and must leave their post at the latest when that minister leaves theirs. A person's appointments should not overlap in the dataset (unless they do so in the source data), but they may be consecutive — for instance when an initially temporary appointment is made permanent, or when a spell of leave is recorded as a posting. The same follows from the minister attachment: if the Prime Minister wishes to replace a minister but keep the sitting state secretary or political advisor, the incumbent must first be dismissed under the departing minister and then reappointed under the incoming one; the same applies when an appointee moves into the equivalent position in a different ministry.

30 Identification and Personal Characteristics

30.1 ID

Numeric. A unique identifier for each individual appointee *within this dataset* (a person retains the same ID across their appointments in POLADV_NOR). It does not link to the same person in the other datasets.

30.2 NSD_Person_ID

Numeric. The NSD (Norwegian Centre for Research Data) person identifier (Sikt, n.d.a), obtained by matching to Sikt's registers of ministers, members of parliament, and state secretaries. Missing for appointees who never held a position covered by Sikt's data.

30.3 first_name

String. The appointee's first name.

30.4 last_name

String. The appointee's last name.

30.5 full_name

String. The appointee's full name (first name followed by last name).

30.6 year_born

Numeric. The appointee's year of birth.

30.7 gender

Dummy. Gender of the appointee: 0 = man, 1 = woman. Coded from the appointee's first name using Statistics Norway's name register (SSB, 2024) and supplemented by manual coding.

30.8 first_name_last_name_year_born

String. A concatenation of first name, last name, and year of birth.

30.9 party_long

String. The full name of the appointee's party. It is parsed from the party abbreviation recorded in the source. Where the party was missing, it was coded manually from public sources, defaulting to the same party as the appointee's minister unless the appointee was clearly non-partisan or from a different party.

31 Appointment, Ministry, and Position

31.1 start_date

Date (YYYY-MM-DD). The date on which the appointee took up the post.

31.2 stop_date

Date (YYYY-MM-DD). The date on which the appointee left the post.

31.3 days_in_office

Numeric. The length of the appointment in days (`stop_date` – `start_date`).

31.4 age_at_start

Numeric. The appointee's age at the start of the appointment.

31.5 ministry

String. The name of the ministry to which the appointee was attached.

31.6 ministry_NSD_ID

Numeric. The NSD ministry code.

31.7 ministry_portfolio

Categorical. A continuity-based ministry portfolio label grouping the various ministry codes into a stable policy area over time. The coding scheme defines 23 categories: Ministry of Defense; Ministry of Auditing; Ministry of Transport and Infrastructure; Ministry of Local Government; Ministry of Public Governance; Ministry of Justice; Ministry of Culture; Ministry of Finance; Ministry of Trade and Industry; Ministry of Foreign Affairs; Ministry of Fisheries; Ministry of Health and Social Affairs; Ministry of Oil and Energy; Ministry of Children and Families; Ministry of Agriculture and Food; Ministry of Climate and Environment; Ministry of Education; Ministry of Labor; Minister Without Portfolio; Prime Minister's Office; The Norwegian Council of State Division in Stockholm; Temporary ministries related to world wars; and WWII illegal ministries.

31.8 position_title

Categorical. The appointee's position title, retained in Norwegian as parsed from the source. The values are: *Statssekretær* (state secretary), *Konstituert statssekretær* (acting state secretary), *Statsministersekretær* (Prime Minister's secretary), *Stabssjef* (chief of staff), *Politisk rådgiver* (political advisor), *Personlig rådgiver* (personal advisor), and *Personlig sekretær* (personal secretary).

31.9 statesec_poladv

Categorical. A two-category grouping of `position_title` indicating the type of appointee: State Secretary (the *Statssekretær*, *Konstituert statssekretær*, *Statsministersekretær*, and *Stabssjef* titles) or Political Advisor (the *Politisk rådgiver*, *Personlig rådgiver*, and *Personlig sekretær* titles).

31.10 temporary_employment

Dummy. Coded 1 if the appointee held the post on a temporary basis, detected from the source text indicating a stand-in (*vikariat*) or a temporary appointment (*konstituert*); 0 otherwise.

31.11 on_leave_of_absence

Dummy. Coded 1 if the source text indicated that the appointee was on leave of absence (*i permisjon*) from the post, 0 otherwise.

31.12 party_cross

Dummy. Coded 1 if the appointee's party (*party_long*) differs from the party of the minister they serve under (*minister_party_long*), 0 if the parties are the same.

32 Minister and Government

32.1 minister_first_name_last_name_year_born

String. The concatenated identifier (first name + last name + birth year) of the minister the appointee serves under, enabling linkage with *Ministers_NOR*.

32.2 minister_NSD_Person_ID

Numeric. The NSD person identifier of the minister the appointee serves under.

32.3 minister_party_long

String. The full name of the party of the minister the appointee serves under.

32.4 government

String. The name of the government the appointee served in, following Regjeringen.no's classification. Note that this classification is *not* equivalent to the government variable in *Governments_NOR* and *Ministers_NOR*.

32.5 link

String. A URL linking to the source record for the appointment on Regjeringen.no.

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